Ford Motor Company

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Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
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TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 02S40: Certain 2000 through 2002 Model Year Taurus and Sable Vehicles Equipped with Adjustable Pedals – Inspection and Adjustment of Pedal Lateral Spacing

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 through 2002 model year Taurus and Sable vehicles equipped with adjustable pedals built at the Atlanta and Chicago Assembly plants from May 3, 1999 through September 14, 2001.

SAFETY CONCERN

Ford has received reports that some of the affected vehicles may have less lateral space between the brake and accelerator pedal than others, resulting in pedal misapplication. The spacing concern is due to manufacturing variability. Simultaneous application of both the brake and accelerator pedals may result in 'unintended vehicle speed increase' or somewhat extended stopping distance. Should such conditions occur, the driver will be able to correct the condition by repositioning his or her foot correctly on the brake pedal and applying the brakes in a normal manner.

SERVICE ACTION

The dealer will inspect the distance between the brake and accelerator pedal and adjust the distance if required. After adjustment, the dealer will re-check pedal lateral spacing.

It is estimated that 90% of affected vehicles will have sufficient pedal lateral distance and will only require inspection to complete this recall. Due to the high estimated inspection rate, and in the interest of customer satisfaction, it is recommended that inspection be performed in the service lane.

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PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter(s)

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……..……....1-800-423-8851
Online Involved Unit Listings ……1-800-555-9601
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Frank M. Ligon

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Safety Recall 02S40:
Certain 2000 Through 2002 Model Year Taurus and Sable Vehicles with Adjustable Pedals
Inspection and Adjustment of Pedal Lateral Spacing

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any of your affected owners whose names are not on your VIN list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

Note: These dealer listings may contain customer names and addresses obtained from Motor Vehicle Registration Records. The use of such motor vehicle registration data for any purpose other than in connection with this recall is a violation of law in several states/provinces/countries. Accordingly, limit the use of this listing to the follow-up necessary to complete this action.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs to adjust lateral pedal spacing which were made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

The use of rental vehicles is not authorized for this program.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Check Clearance-No Adjustment Required	02S40A	0.1 Hour
Check and Adjust at Pivot Bolts	02S40B	0.2 Hour
Check and Adjust at Pivot Bolts and Anchor Nuts	02S40C	0.3 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

NOTE: Only one (1) labor operation (A, B or C) will be allowed per claim in combination with misc. expense code "ADMIN". ACES II edits will reject multiple labor operations.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

No parts are required for this recall.

NOTE: In some of the affected vehicles, the left, outboard accelerator pedal bracket anchor nut was intentionally not installed during the assembly process. It does not affect pedal operation. It is not necessary to install the missing nut when checking or adjusting the pedal lateral spacing or when replacing a pedal assembly.

ROTUNDA SPECIAL TOOL REQUIREMENTS

Rotunda Special Tool OTC 206-088 is utilized in this recall during inspection and pedal adjustment.

The special tool serves two (2) functions: One end of the tool performs a "checking" function (for inspection) between the brake and accelerator pedal. The other end of the tool performs a "setting" function (for pedal adjustment) between the two pedals.

Rotunda Special Tool OTC 206-088 has been shipped to the dealership (quantity of 2 tools per dealer). It is expected that tools will arrive at the dealership the week of October 20, 2002. Additional tools may be ordered at no-charge by calling the Special Service Support Center at 1-800-325-5621.

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